

THEME CREATORS AND MANAGERS

Convert your desktop into an aquarium, a space frontier, a forest, or even make it look like da Vinci's desktop!



Desktop Architect

Desktop Architect is a versatile tool which helps you install, customise and create Windows themes with ease

Play with themes

If you've installed hundreds of themes, managing them can be a great nuisance. Desktop Architect provides a great interface through which you can manage

themes better—the main window lists all themes installed on your system.

Click on the 'Apply' icon to apply the selected theme to the Windows environment.

You'll find a group of four icons next to the 'Apply' button, while the main window displays a preview of the currently selected theme.

Clicking on these icons will let you hide/reveal wallpapers, icons, and windows and see the full/empty status of the recycle bin. This helps you view the individual components of the theme and decide whether to apply



Desktop Architect lists all installed themes

the same to your Windows environment or not.

Make your own theme

Desktop Architect as such does not provide you with options to create a new theme. But once you have the wallpapers, startup/shutdown screens and screensavers of your choice, you can pack them together as a theme.

Select any theme from the drop-down list in the main window. The preview window on the right of the main window shows you the basic visual components of the theme, such as icons, mouse pointers, logos, desktop, appearance, and sounds.

Click on the 'Desktop' tab and browse to select a screensaver and wallpaper that you've created.

The 'Appearance' tab lists all the colour schemes installed on your PC. You can save/delete any of those listed.

The 'Item' drop down list shows all the components for which parameters such as font, colour, size, etc are required. You can select the item of your choice and set its parameters.

Clicking on the 'Sounds' tab displays the current sound theme. If you've made your own WAV files, use them in the theme package. You can also use the sound recorder to record some snazzy captions in your voice. (Make sure the WAV files are small, else they would be intrusive to the user.)

The 'Logos' tab displays the default startup/shutdown



Pack your Theme

Choose a folder where you can save your theme file and related files. This helps you while you're packaging your theme as a distribution file, for if you don't save the files together, you'll lose most of the data while packaging your theme.

screens. Use the logos or images you created for these screens here. Browse to select the appropriate logos for the appropriate screens.

From your collection of downloaded and accumulated icons and pointers, select the best ones and pack them in your theme.

The final step is the simplest—click the Floppy icon on the toolbar or choose 'Save' from the File menu. You will be prompted for a name and a path for the theme you've created.

Enter the filename and the path for saving your theme. It will be saved as a .theme file.

Package your own theme

The .theme file you created under 'Make your own theme' has references to all the objects such as wallpapers, screensavers, etc within it. If you wish to create a whole theme pack that includes all your theme files for distribution, use the package tool available with Desktop Architect.

Click on the globe icon in



Linux blues? Cure them all!

Free Linux CD with the June issue of **digit**